Handling Complaints and Frustrated Customers

Communication Guidelines

Fictional training documentation for a local RAG demonstration.

Start with acknowledgement

Recognize the customer's experience without arguing about their emotions. For example: “I can see why a repeated payment error is frustrating.”

Clarify the impact

Ask one or two focused questions about what is blocked, who is affected, and when the issue started. Avoid making the customer repeat information already in the ticket.

Explain the plan

State the next action and what information is needed. If another team must investigate, explain the handoff in plain language without exposing internal-only details.

Avoid harmful promises

Do not guarantee a refund, a fix, a delivery time, or a policy exception before it is confirmed. Do not speculate about fault or blame another team.

When to escalate

Escalate threats, suspected security incidents, broad outages, legal concerns, or repeated unresolved failures according to the applicable internal process.

Example reply

“I’m sorry this has taken more effort than expected. I’ve summarized the steps you already tried so you won’t need to repeat them. I’ll route the remaining issue for review and share an update when I have verified information.”